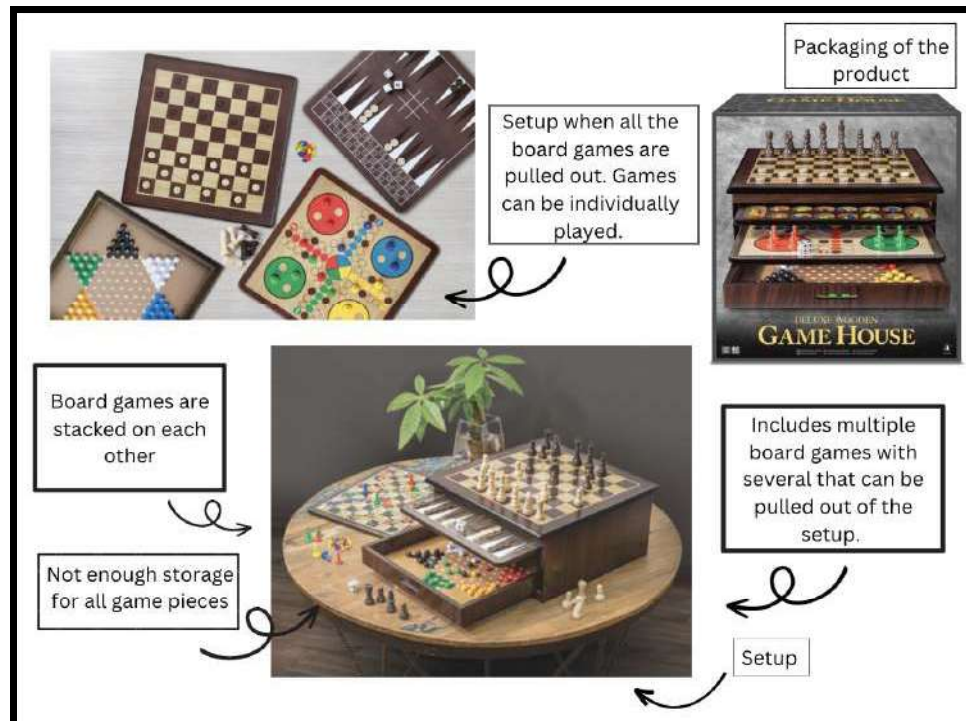


	How much does 15x15 inches of this wood cost?	Secondary- Websites	help me understand which wood can be used which is environmentally friendly.	
Safety	What are some safety precautions incorporated in board games?	Secondary- Websites	Based on the safety precautions taken in existing board games, I can incorporate such precautions in my product along with certain new precautions.	12
SIZE	What is the average size of a board game?	Secondary- Websites, Existing Products.	The average size of the board can make sure that the product that I aim to create is not too small or too big. This product should include the regular board games in a space saving manner.	10
FUNCTION	What are the most common family board games?	Secondary- Websites Primary- Interview	This product should include commonly played games so that people can enjoy the games and it is popular within all age groups.	5
	How to play Checkers?	Secondary- Instructional Videos	After conducting some research, I learned that checkers is a common game. But I did not know how this game works and the parameters required for this game. And hence I needed to learn how to play the game in order to design the board game.	6

A3: Analyse a range of existing products that inspire a solution to the problem

When creating a solution, It is essential to take into account the existing product that caters to the mentioned problem. We need to evaluate the products based on the strengths and weaknesses. I have chosen 4 different existing products that all fall under the same category that combine board games and bring people together over said games.

Existing Product 1: Deluxe Wooden Game House⁴

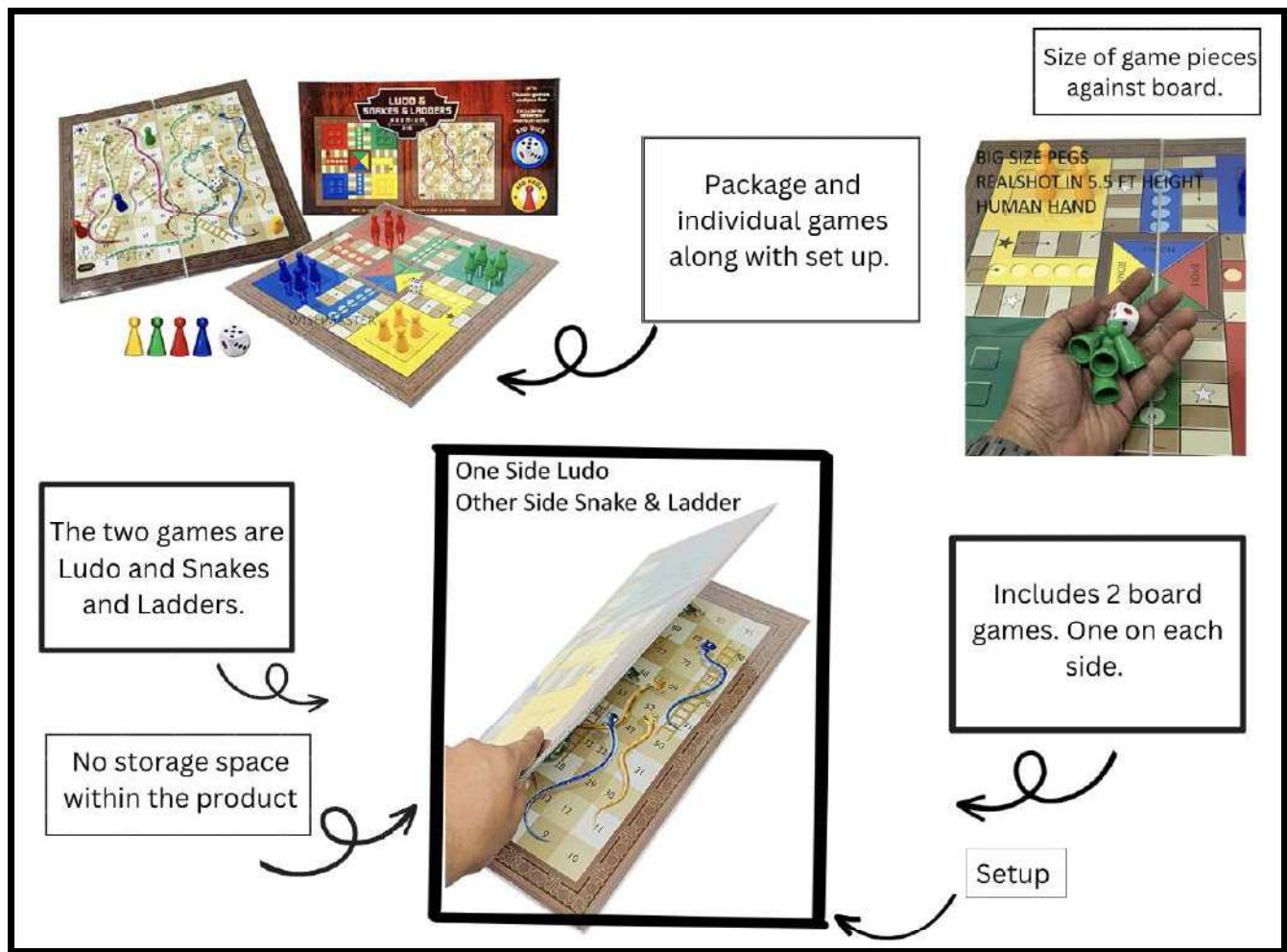


⁴ Citation for all existing products are in the Bibliography

Criteria	Strength	Weakness
Aesthetics	(i) This product includes different shades of wood. Depending on the game, each rack is designed. There are 4 games in this product; chess, backgammon, snakes and ladders and chinese checkers. (ii) The game pieces are colourful. They consist of colours such as red, green, white, brown, blue, yellow.	(i) All the boards follow the dull colour scheme. I think the colour of the board should have consisted of the same shades. Both the chess and backgammon boards follow the board shades but they do not fall in the same spectrum of colours. I think if the board was uniformed it would be better along with colourful game pieces that would bring some colour to the games.
Customer	(i) The product is designed for families and groups of friends, making it perfect for socialising and bonding. The game is suitable for both two-player and multiplayer games.	(i) The product is marketed solely to ages 6-12, limiting the target audience.
Cost	(i) The cost of this product is \$24.99. The cost of the product is affordable, making it accessible to a wider range of customers	(i) The cost of making the game is unknown, which makes it difficult to determine whether the price is fair.
Environment	(i) As this product is made out of wood, this product will impact the environment. Furthermore, some of the game pieces are made out of plastic which is extremely difficult to recycle.	
Safety	(i) This board game is quite sturdy and hence there are less chances of the board game breaking and hurting someone.	(i) When looking at the safety aspect of this product, there are several flaws in this product. The edges are quite sharp. Additionally, there are many tiny game pieces which can be harmful for a child. These game pieces can easily get lost as well.
Size	(i) The exact size of the entire product cannot be determined as there is no mention of the same in the website, but each of the boards seem to be an average board size in one of the pictures on the website and hence It can be said that each non foldable board is 10x10 inches.	
Function	(i) This board game is in the form of a box. There is a board game on the upper surface of the box. And there are a few functional drawers that are pulled out with other board games within the same. There are 3 of these drawers with the games; chess, backgammon, snakes and ladders and chinese checkers.	(i) When looking at the functional aspect of this game, only the lower drawer has a handle. The rest of them need to be pulled out. When it comes to convenience, this is not the most convenient way of playing these games.
Material	(i) The strengths of this board game is that it is entirely made of wood which is good for the environment.	(i) But when we talk about the negative aspects of the same, it can be said that because this product is entirely made out of wood, the sharp edges are increasingly dangerous for kids to be around as it can hurt someone.

In conclusion, this product has several advantages, including its affordability, eco-friendliness, and functional design. However, there are some flaws, such as potential safety hazards, dull aesthetics, and functional inconvenience. Overall, it appears that the product is appropriate for families and groups of friends who want to play traditional board games together.

Existing Product 2: One side: Ludo, Other side: Snakes and Ladders

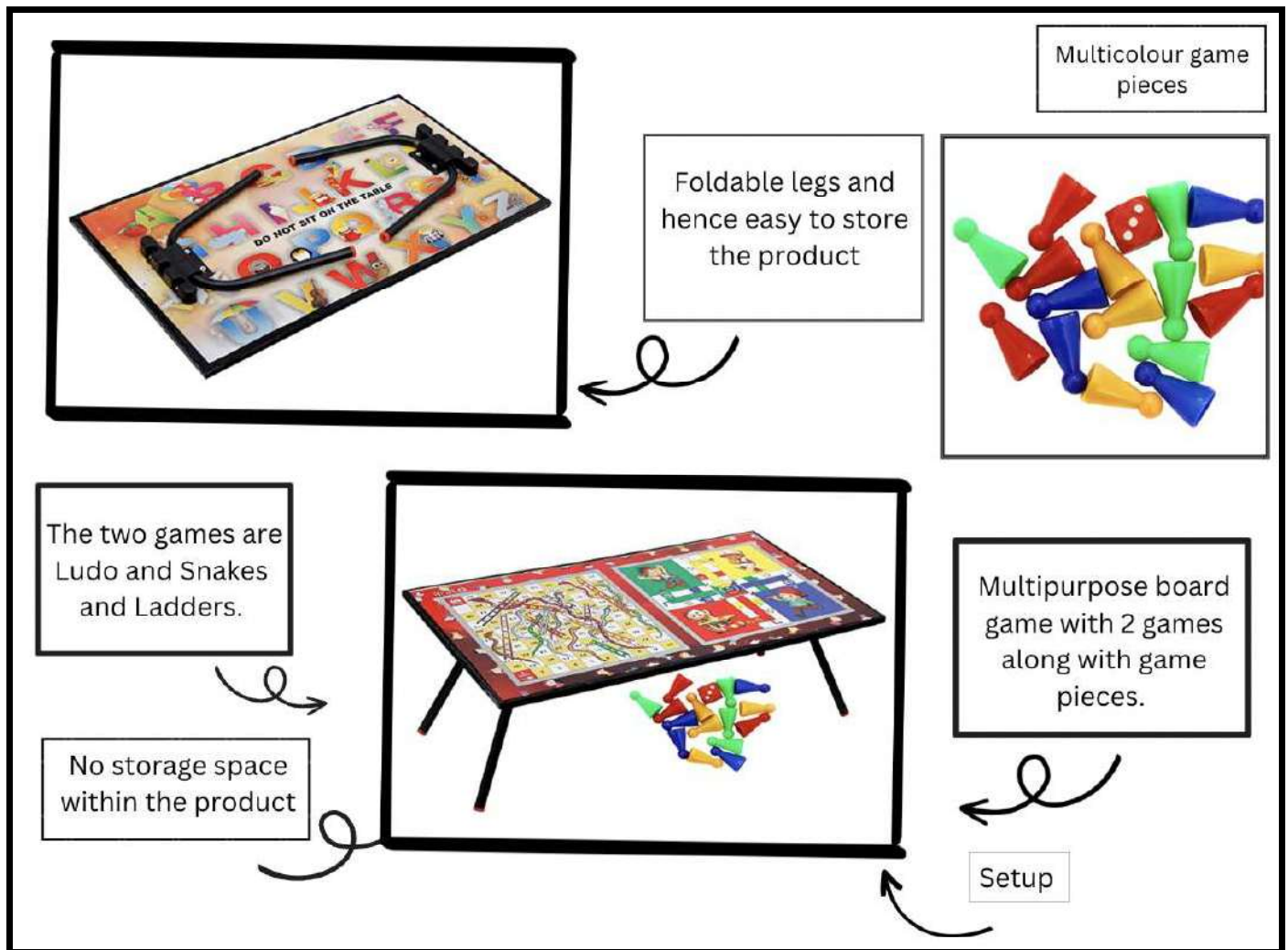


Criteria	Strength	Weakness
Aesthetics	(i) This board has 2 sides and hence includes 2 games. These games are Ludo and Snake and Ladders. (ii) Both sides have a beige border with a minimal pattern. The Ludo board is a classic design and the Snakes and Ladders game follows the colour scheme of beige, yellow and blue. (iii) Both sides of the board are covered with plastic.	(i) The ladder on the snakes and ladder side should be a bit more highlighted. As the entire side follows the beige colour scheme, the ladder is barely visible. (ii) Additionally, the yellow snake should be replaced with another colour so that it is more visible.
Customer	(i) The product is suitable for families with 4 members or for a group of friends. Anyone over the age of 3 years old can play the games. (ii) Both games include 4 player options.	(i) The game includes small pieces that can be hazardous for children under the age of 3 years old.
Cost	(i) The cost of the product is \$5.78 to purchase but the cost for making the product cannot be determined.	
Environment	(i) As this game is covered with plastic on both sides, when disposed of, there will be a negative impact on the environment.	
Safety	(i) This plastic on the board prevents damage to dust, settling on the cardboard or any other food item that might destroy the game. And hence it is durable.	(i) This game does include sharp corners and the plastic can create sharper edges. And Hence this game is not extremely safe for children under the age of 5.

Size	(i) The board is a 14 x14 inch board. One board includes 2 board games (one of each side). The game pieces in this product are the “big size pegs” as mentioned in this product.	
Function	(i) This product includes 2 games. There are 2 sides and each side has 1 game. These games are Ludo and Snakes and Ladders. (ii) This board can be folded from the centre. This makes it easier to travel with. This helps in the storage aspect.	(i) There are only 2 games on this board. And this board does not have storage for the game pieces and hence this game will likely take more space then it shows.
Material	(i) This product is a cardboard board with a plastic cover. Additionally, the game pieces are also made out of plastic.	

In conclusion, this item is a dual-sided board game that includes the classic games of Ludo and Snakes and Ladders. It is appropriate for families with four members or groups of friends of any age over three years old. It should be noted, however, that small game pieces can be dangerous to children under the age of three. The board is made of cardboard with a plastic cover that ensures durability but may have an environmental impact when discarded. While the product is functional and portable, it lacks game piece storage and may take up more space than expected. Furthermore, there are some safety concerns regarding sharp corners and plastic edges.

Existing Product 3: Multi-Purpose Table with Ludo and Snakes and Ladders

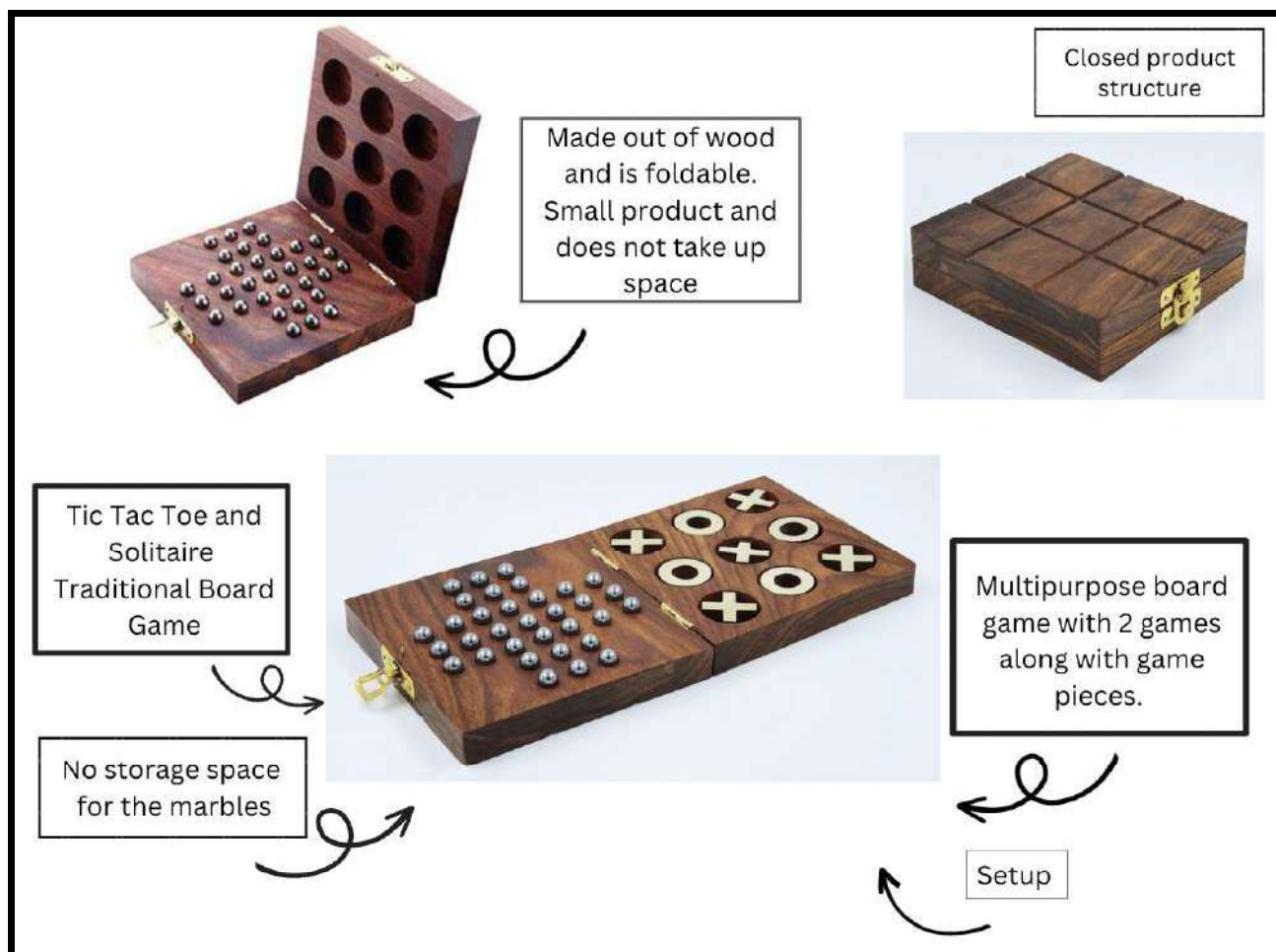


Criteria	Strength	Weakness
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Aesthetics	(i) This product is in the form of a table. This table is a classic table with 4 legs. This table includes 2 games (Snakes and Ladders and Ludo) which are placed side by side on the top of the table. The game of Ludo seems like a children's version of the same with cartoons. (ii) Both games are a part of the design of the table. The background colour is red with some patterns. The table is outlined with black. The legs of the table are also black. This table also includes colour game pieces and a dice. These game pieces can be used for both games.		(i) Every aspect of this board game is extremely colour full. If the background was a light colour, they would make the board games more prominents. And this board is not very appealing to the eye.
Customer	(i) The customers for this product are children under the age of 7 years old. This can be determined based on the design of the table and the games. Furthermore, the length of the table legs are comparatively less giving the idea that this product is for children.		
Cost	(i) This product cost \$4.88 to purchase but the amount spent on the making of the product cannot be determined.		
Environment	(i) Like any physical product, this product will have a minor impact on the environment due to the use of wood in the product. But apart from the game pieces, there is no use of plastic in this product. And hence this product will not have a major impact on the environment. But this product will not be considered environment friendly.		
Safety	(i) This product is not safe for children under the age of 3 years as it consists of tiny game pieces. Additionally, this game does have corners which are not smoothened or covered for protection. This is essential as this product is meant for children.		
Size	(i) The size of the product is not mentioned but this product is meant for children and we are aware that it is a low table.		
Function	(i) This product does include fun and colourful characters which are appealing to younger kids. It also includes a wide range of colours. (i) This table is not a tall table and hence is ideal for young kids to use. (iii) Additionally, the legs are foldable which makes the product easy to store.	(i) This product is an interactive table where kids can sit and play games. These games are multiplayer games. And hence would require 2 or more players. (ii) A problem that can be faced based on the functionality of this product is the arrangement of the same. A game like Ludo required a maximum of 4 people and the players would be required to gather around the table. But the game is put on one side of the board and hence, it can be inconvenient for the 4th player sitting on the other side of the table to play.	
Material	(i) The product top is made out of wood. The edges are covered with black tape and the legs are made out of steel/metal. The game pieces though are made out of plastic.		

In closing, the table-top board game is intended for young children under the age of seven. Snakes and Ladders and Ludo are two popular games on the table, with colourful game pieces and dice. The table's design is not very visually appealing, with a red background and black outlining, but it is meant for children. While the product is foldable and easy to store, the game pieces are potentially dangerous to children under the age of three, and the corners are not protected for safety. Because it is made of wood and plastic, the product is not environmentally friendly. The table is intended for multiplayer games, but placing the games on one side of the board may be inconvenient for the fourth player. Overall, while the product has some advantages, it also has some disadvantages that should be considered before purchasing.

Existing Product 4: Wooden Tic Tac Toe and Solitaire Traditional Board Game



Criteria	Strength	Weakness
Aesthetics	(i) This game consists of 2 games (X and O and peg solitaire). This is completely made out of wood. The entire product is tinted Darkrich mahogany. This is a foldable game which has peg solitaire on one side and a game of X and O on the other. The overall visuals of this product is quite appealing because of its simplicity	(i) While this product can be quite appealing to a larger audience, it may not necessarily appeal to children as there is no design. This design also excludes bright colours that children tend to find appealing.
Customer	(i) This product's customer is not explicitly mentioned. However, it is reasonable to expect that the product will appeal to a broad range of customers, including families, friends, and people who enjoy playing board games. Because the product includes two games, one for one player and one for two, it can accommodate both single and multiple players.	
Cost	(i) This product is sold at \$9.76. The cost of making is not mentioned and cannot be determined due to lack of information regarding the exact material used in this product.	
Environment	(i) This product will have a minor impact on the environment because this is entirely made out of wood. But there is no use of harmful substances such as plastic.	
Safety	(i) The corners are not smoothened or covered and it is not safe for children. Apart from this, the product is sturdy and hence has less chances of breaking.	
Size	(i) Based on the information on the website, the	(i) This game only includes 2 games. One of

	product follows the given dimensions; Length: 4.75 Inches, Width: 4.75 Inches, Height: 1.5 Inches. This acts as an advantage because this product is quite small. This means that it is easy to store and travel with.	which is a one player game and the other game is a 2 player game. This is restricting as multiple people cannot get together.
Function	(i) This is a foldable game. Peg solitaire is a one player game. And the other game is a two player game. (ii) There is no storage space in this product for the marbles required for peg solitaire and the x and o pieces.	
Material	(i) This product is completely made out of durable fine wood. The game pieces such as the marbles are made out of marbles and the tic tac toe pieces seem to be made out of either paper/cardboard.	

A4: Develop a detailed design brief that summarises the analysis of relevant research

Board games have long been a favourite pastime for people of all ages. However, one of the most difficult aspects of owning board games is finding enough space to store them. This can be especially difficult for families with children over the age of six, who tend to accumulate more games over time. To **address** this issue, I intend to **create** a design that combines multiple board games while taking up less space. The first step in **designing** this solution was to conduct extensive research into the needs of the target audience. This research included both primary and secondary research. This further required conducting surveys or interviews with families to **explore** the types of board games they enjoy playing and the amount of storage space they have available.

Survey⁵:

Surveying or interviewing families about their board game preferences can provide information not only about storage requirements, but also about the specific types of games that are popular among the target audience. I further used some of this information to

What board games do you play? (List)

I like chess

no

Ticket to ride, sequence, code names, monopoly

i dont

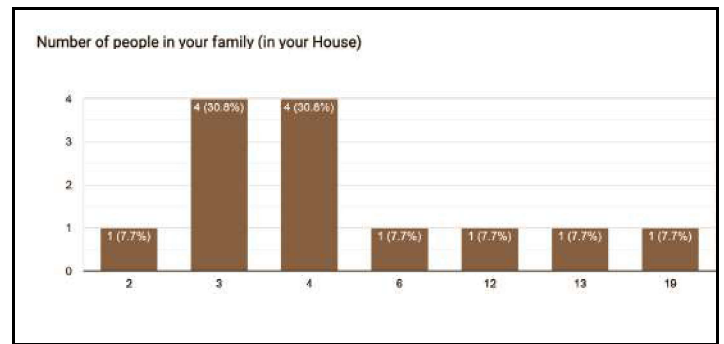
Monopoly

cards against humanity

Ludo, Monopoly, Clue,

house, life, ludo, monopoly

ludo, code names, ticket to ride, snakes and ladders,



create a product that meets the needs and interests of the target audience. Firstly I needed to understand the number of people in an average family. This answer ranged from 2 all the way to 19. The best way to **collect** data will be finding the most common answer and stem my research from there. Based on the information in the survey, families with 3-4 members were repeatedly mentioned. This helped me understand that ideally these games should be 2-4 player games to include multiple people and bring several people together. This product should not include one player games as that defeats the purpose of bringing communities together with board games.

In this case, the survey revealed information about popular board games such as Ticket to Ride and Codenames that I was not previously aware of. As a result, the designer decided to conduct additional research on these games in order to better understand their gameplay mechanics and design elements. And further **analyse** the relevance of these games in the product that needs to be designed.

Interviews⁶:

Here is a short **summary** of the interviews that I conducted and the key points from these interviews.

⁵ Survey Responses: Appendix A.2

⁶ Evidence for Interviews is A.3